

Developmental Psychology

*Comprehensive EPPP Preparation Study Guide
For Destynee | Dr. DeDe's Concept List*

Based on DSM-5-TR and Peer-Reviewed Research

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1. Identity Consolidation

Definition: The process by which adolescents integrate various aspects of their identity (values, beliefs, goals, vocational aspirations) into a coherent sense of self.

Whose Idea: James Marcia (based on Erik Erikson's work on identity formation)

Research Context: Marcia's identity status paradigm includes four statuses: identity achievement, foreclosure, moratorium, and diffusion. Consolidation represents movement toward achievement.

Source: Marcia, J. E. (1966). Development and validation of ego-identity status. *Journal of Personality and Social Psychology*, 3(5), 551-558.

2. Internal Working Model

Definition: A cognitive framework comprising mental representations of self, others, and relationships that is formed through early attachment experiences and influences future relationship expectations and behaviors.

Whose Idea: John Bowlby (Attachment Theory)

Significance: Bowlby proposed that infants develop internal working models of attachment figures that serve as templates for future relationships, affecting expectations about trust, security, and interpersonal dynamics throughout life.

Source: Bowlby, J. (1969/1982). *Attachment and loss: Vol. 1. Attachment*. Basic Books.

3. Erikson's 8 Stages of Psychosocial Development

Whose Idea: Erik Erikson

Stage	Age	Crisis	Virtue
1	0-1 year	Trust vs. Mistrust	Hope
2	1-3 years	Autonomy vs. Shame/Doubt	Will
3	3-6 years	Initiative vs. Guilt	Purpose
4	6-12 years	Industry vs. Inferiority	Competence
5	12-18 years	Identity vs. Role Confusion	Fidelity
6	Young Adulthood	Intimacy vs. Isolation	Love
7	Middle Adulthood	Generativity vs. Stagnation	Care
8	Late Adulthood	Integrity vs. Despair	Wisdom

Source: Erikson, E. H. (1963). *Childhood and society* (2nd ed.). Norton.

4. Piaget's Theory of Cognitive Development

Whose Idea: Jean Piaget

Four Stages:

1. **Sensorimotor (0-2 years):** Infants know world through senses/actions. Develop object permanence.
2. **Preoperational (2-7 years):** Symbolic thought, language development. Limitations: egocentrism, centration, irreversibility, lack of conservation.
3. **Concrete Operational (7-11 years):** Logical thought about concrete events. Conservation, reversibility, decentration.
4. **Formal Operational (11+ years):** Abstract reasoning, hypothetical-deductive reasoning, propositional thought.

Key Concepts: - **Assimilation:** Fitting new info into existing schemas - **Accommodation:** Modifying schemas to fit new info - **Scheme:** Cognitive structure organizing knowledge

Source: Piaget, J., & Inhelder, B. (1969). *The psychology of the child*. Basic Books.

5. Zone of Proximal Development (ZPD)

Definition: The distance between what a learner can do independently and what they can achieve with guidance from a more knowledgeable person (scaffolding).

Whose Idea: Lev Vygotsky

Key Concepts: - Upper limit with scaffolding - Lower limit of independent performance - Optimal learning occurs within ZPD - Scaffolding supports progression through ZPD

Source: Vygotsky, L. S. (1978). *Mind in society: The development of higher psychological processes*. Harvard University Press.

6. Attachment Theory and the Strange Situation

Strange Situation Procedure: Laboratory observation of infant-caregiver separation/reunion to assess attachment quality.

Whose Experiment: Mary Ainsworth

Four Attachment Patterns: - **Secure:** Distressed at separation, easily comforted upon reunion - **Avoidant:** Little distress at separation, avoids caregiver upon reunion - **Ambivalent/Resistant:** Very distressed at separation, difficult to comfort upon reunion - **Disorganized:** Inconsistent, confused behaviors; associated with maltreatment

Internal Working Model: Mental representations of self and others formed through early attachment.

Source: Ainsworth, M. D. S., et al. (1978). *Patterns of attachment: A psychological study of the strange situation*. Lawrence Erlbaum.

7. Language Development Theories

Nativist Perspective (Chomsky): - Language Acquisition Device (LAD) - Universal Grammar (innate structural principles) - Poverty of the stimulus argument

Behaviorist Perspective (Skinner): - Language learned through operant conditioning - Imitation and reinforcement

Social Interactionist Perspective: - Language develops through social interaction - Joint attention, caregiver responsiveness

Key Milestones: - Cooing (2-4 months) - Babbling (6-9 months) - First words (10-14 months) - Vocabulary spurt (18-24 months) - Two-word stage (18-24 months) - Telegraphic speech (2-3 years)

Source: Chomsky, N. (1965). *Aspects of the theory of syntax*. MIT Press; Skinner, B. F. (1957). *Verbal behavior*. Appleton-Century-Crofts.

8. Deferred Imitation

Definition: The ability to reproduce a modeled behavior after a delay (hours, days, or weeks), demonstrating representational memory.

Why It Matters: - Indicates the development of symbolic/representational thought - Emerges around 9 months, expands significantly in toddlerhood - Evidence of developing memory systems and observational learning - Foundation for language acquisition and cultural transmission

Whose Idea: Jean Piaget (sensorimotor stage); further researched by Andrew Meltzoff

Source: Meltzoff, A. N. (1988). Infant imitation after a 1-week delay: Long-term memory for novel acts and multiple stimuli. *Developmental Psychology*, 24(4), 470-476.

9. Object Permanence

Definition: Understanding that objects continue to exist even when out of sight.

Development: Develops gradually during sensorimotor stage; full understanding around 8-12 months.

A-not-B Error: Infants search for hidden object at location A even after seeing it moved to location B (7-12 months).

Whose Idea: Jean Piaget

Source: Piaget, J. (1954). *The construction of reality in the child*. Basic Books.

10. Conservation

Definition: Understanding that quantity remains the same despite changes in appearance.

Types: Number, mass, liquid, area, weight, volume conservation.

Acquisition: Gradually acquired during concrete operational stage (ages 7-11).

Related Concepts: - **Centration:** Focusing on one feature only (preoperational limitation) - **Decentration:** Considering multiple features simultaneously - **Irreversibility:** Inability to mentally reverse operations - **Reversibility:** Ability to mentally reverse operations

Whose Idea: Jean Piaget

Source: Piaget, J., & Inhelder, B. (1969). *The psychology of the child*. Basic Books.

11. Preoperational Stage Characteristics

Ages: 2-7 years

Key Features: - Symbolic thought and language - Egocentrism (difficulty taking others' perspectives) - Animistic thinking (attributing life to objects) - Magical thinking (thoughts cause events) - Centration (focusing on one aspect) - Irreversibility (cannot mentally reverse operations) - Lack of conservation

Whose Idea: Jean Piaget

Source: Piaget, J., & Inhelder, B. (1969). *The psychology of the child*. Basic Books.

12. Formal Operational Thinking

Definition: The final stage of Piaget's theory (ages 11+), characterized by abstract reasoning, hypothetical-deductive reasoning, systematic problem-solving, and metacognition.

Key Abilities: - Abstract thinking - Hypothetico-deductive reasoning - Systematic experimentation - Propositional logic (evaluating logic without real-world reference) - Metacognition (thinking about thinking)

Hypothetico-Deductive Reasoning: Formulating hypotheses and systematically testing them through deduction.

Whose Idea: Jean Piaget

Criticism: Not all adults reach this stage; performance varies by domain.

Source: Inhelder, B., & Piaget, J. (1958). *The growth of logical thinking from childhood to adolescence*. Basic Books.

13. Fast Mapping

Definition: The rapid acquisition of new vocabulary by inferring a word's meaning from limited exposure and context.

Vocabulary Development: - Children can learn new words after only 1-2 exposures - Relies on constraints (whole object assumption, mutual exclusivity, taxonomic assumption) - Explains rapid vocabulary growth (vocabulary spurt at 18-24 months)

Source: Carey, S. (1978). The child as word learner. In M. Halle et al. (Eds.), *Linguistic theory and psychological reality* (pp. 264-293). MIT Press.

14. Joint Attention

Definition: Shared focus on object or event by two people; involves eye contact, pointing, or following gaze.

Emerges: 9-12 months

Significance: Critical for language development and social cognition; foundational for theory of mind.

Source: Mundy, P., & Newell, L. (2007). Attention, joint attention, and social cognition. *Current Directions in Psychological Science*.

15. Theory of Mind

Definition: Understanding that others have thoughts, beliefs, desires different from one's own.

Emerges: 3-5 years

False Belief Task: Child predicts behavior based on another's false belief (Sally-Anne test).

Significance: Critical for social understanding, empathy, communication.

Deficits: Associated with autism spectrum disorder.

Source: Premack, D., & Woodruff, G. (1978). Does the chimpanzee have a theory of mind? *Behavioral and Brain Sciences*.

16. Emergent Literacy

Definition: Skills and knowledge that precede and develop into conventional literacy; begins in early childhood.

Components: - Print awareness (print carries meaning) - Phonological awareness (sounds in language) - Letter knowledge - Storybook reading experiences

Source: Whitehurst, G. J., & Lonigan, C. J. (1998). Child development and emergent literacy. *Child Development*.

17. Phonics vs Whole Language

Phonics: Teaching reading by correlating sounds with letters/groups of letters; explicit instruction in sound-letter relationships.

Whole Language: Teaching reading through immersion in meaningful text; emphasis on context and whole words.

Which is Best: **Phonics** - Research (National Reading Panel, 2000) shows systematic phonics instruction is more effective, especially for struggling readers. Balanced approach combining both is common.

Source: National Reading Panel (2000). *Teaching children to read: An evidence-based assessment of the scientific research literature on reading and its implications for reading instruction*. NICHD.

18. Social Constructivist Classroom

Definition: A learning environment where knowledge is actively constructed through social interaction.

Whose Idea: Lev Vygotsky (ZPD); extended by Jerome Bruner

Key Features: - Collaborative learning - Teacher as facilitator/guide - Scaffolding support - Authentic, meaningful tasks - Peer interaction and dialogue

Source: Vygotsky, L. S. (1978). *Mind in society: The development of higher psychological processes*. Harvard University Press.

19. Private Speech

Definition: Self-directed speech children use to guide thinking and behavior; eventually becomes inner speech.

Whose Idea: Lev Vygotsky (contrast with Piaget who viewed it as egocentric)

Function: Self-regulation, planning, problem-solving.

Source: Vygotsky, L. S. (1987). *Thinking and speech*. Plenum Press.

20. Continuity vs Discontinuity

Continuity View: Development is gradual, cumulative, and quantitative; skills build upon earlier abilities.

Discontinuity View: Development occurs in distinct, qualitatively different stages; abrupt changes transform abilities.

Resolution: Most theorists acknowledge both; development shows both continuous (small incremental changes) and discontinuous (stage-like shifts) aspects.

Source: Lerner, R. M. (2002). *Concepts and theories of human development* (3rd ed.). Lawrence Erlbaum.

21. Sensitive Period vs Critical Period

Feature	Critical Period	Sensitive Period
Timing	Fixed, limited window	Broader timeframe
Consequences	Permanent, irreversible deficits	Reduced but not impossible learning
Example	Visual development	Language acquisition

Source: Knudsen, E. I. (2004). Sensitive periods in the development of the brain and behavior. *Journal of Cognitive Neuroscience*.

22. Imprinting

Definition: Rapid, irreversible learning occurring during a critical period in which an animal forms an attachment to the first moving object it sees (typically the mother).

Whose Research: Konrad Lorenz (ducklings following him)

Critical Period: Brief window shortly after hatching/birth.

Source: Lorenz, K. (1935). Der Kumpan in der Umwelt des Vogels. *Journal of Ornithology*.